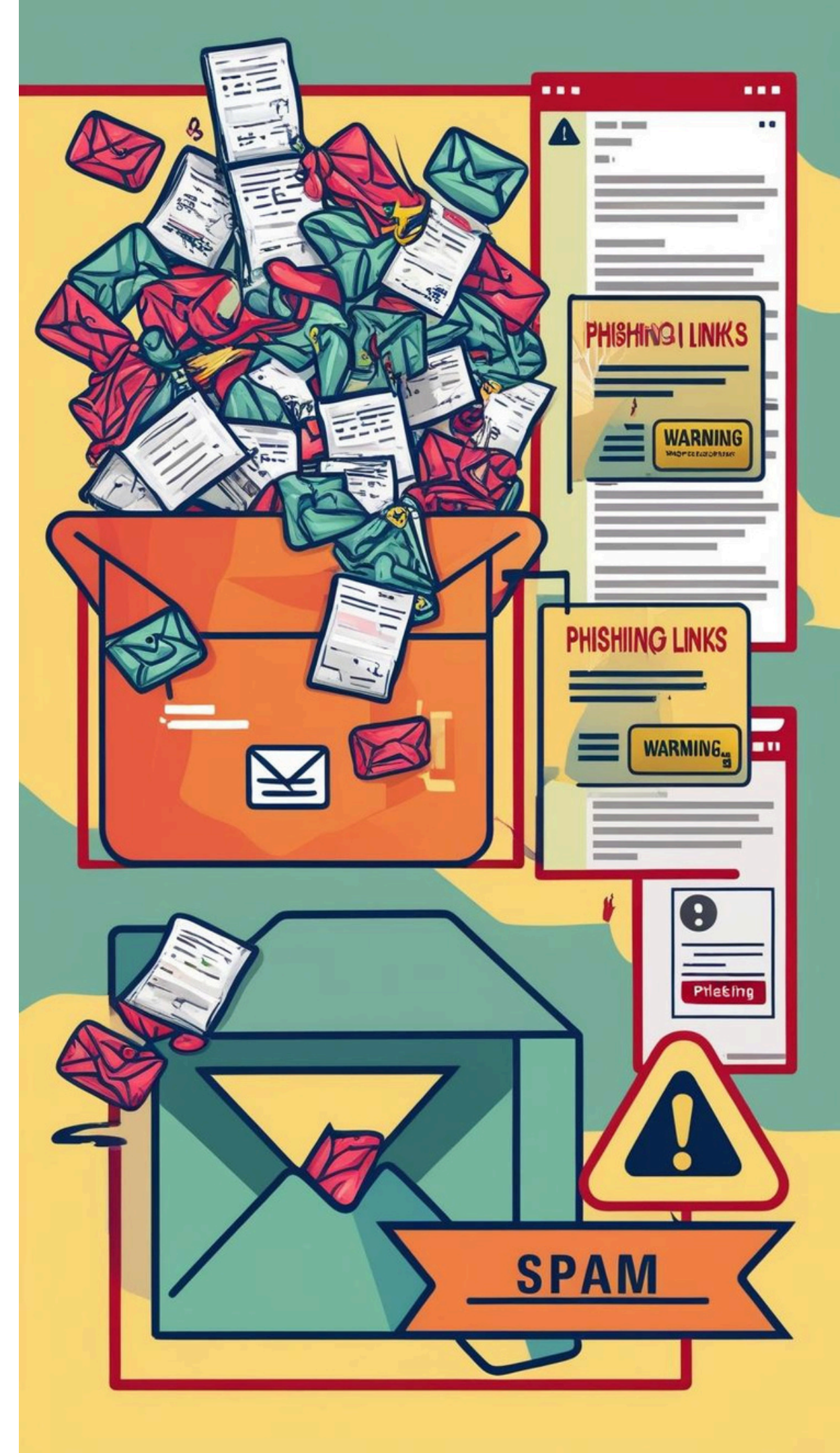
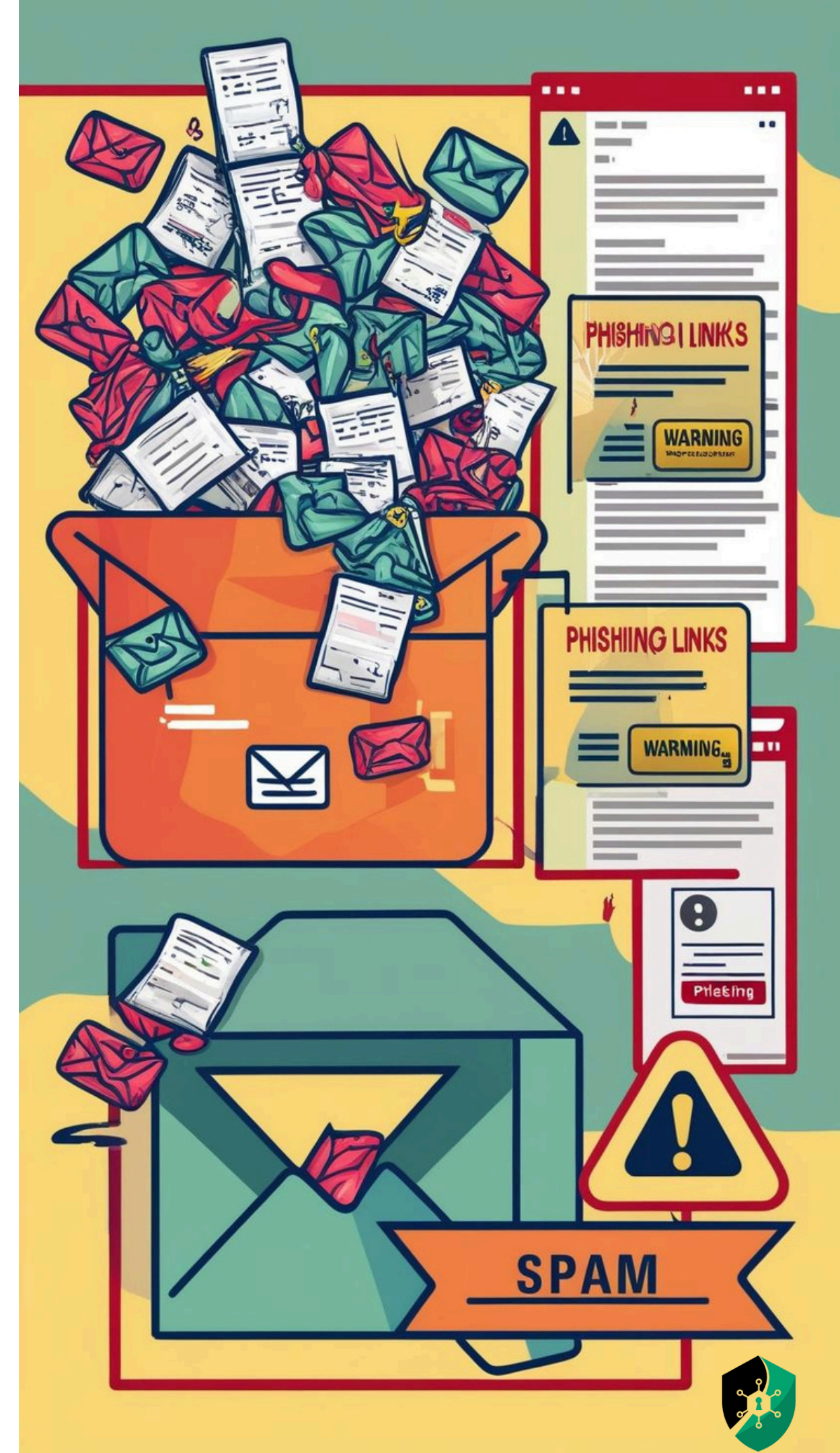


Spam vs Phishing



Spam vs Phishing

Both unwanted but not the same and differ greatly in purpose and risk



Spam

- Mass-marketing messages
- Unsolicited ads or promotions
- Newsletters you never signed up for
- Random sales pitches or “too good to be true” offers



Key Characteristics

- Annoying but usually not harmful
- Sent to many people at once
- Often filtered by email providers automatically
- Examples: Ads for weight loss pills, fake luxury watches, cryptocurrency schemes



Tries to trick you into ...

- Revealing sensitive information (passwords, bank info, etc.)
- Clicking on harmful links or attachments
- Downloading malware onto your device
- Sending money or gift cards to a scammer



Key Characteristics

- Carefully crafted to look real and trustworthy
- Often appears to come from a familiar sender (your bank, IT support, manager)
- Can be **targeted** or mass-sent
- Carries real danger for you and your organization



Side-by-Side Examples

Example Type	Subject Line	Intent
Spam	☐ Crazy Sale on Sunglasses – 90% Off!	Get you to buy something
Phishing	Your Account Will Be Locked – Verify Now	Steal login credentials
Spam	Congratulations! You’ve won a cruise!	Promote fake services/offers
Phishing	Urgent: Wire Payment Requested	Trick employee into sending funds



Quick Tip

If it's just annoying, it's probably spam.

If it's asking you to act, click, or give up something sensitive—it might be phishing.



Why Distinction Matters

- Spam is usually filtered and poses little risk if ignored.
- Phishing requires awareness—because one mistake can lead to serious consequences.



Whether you're checking your personal inbox or your work email, being able to tell the difference helps you take the right action: ignore vs. report.

